method in the processing of any request. (A `DoubleRenderError` exception is thrown on the second render.)

Because the controller must respond exactly once, it checks to see whether a response has been generated just before it finishes handling a request. If not, the controller looks for a template named after the controller and action and automatically renders it. This is the most common way that rendering takes place. You may have noticed that in most of the actions in our shopping cart tutorial we never explicitly rendered anything. Instead, our action methods set up the context for the view and return. The controller notices that no rendering has taken place and automatically invokes the appropriate template.

You can have multiple templates with the same name but with different extensions (for example, `.html.erb`, `.xml.builder`, and `.js.erb`). If you don't specify an extension in a render request, Rails assumes `html.erb`.

Rendering Templates

A *template* is a file that defines the content of a response for our application. Rails supports three template formats out of the box: *erb*, which is embedded Ruby code (typically with HTML); *builder*, a more programmatic way of constructing XML content; and *RJS*, which generates JavaScript. We'll talk about the contents of these files starting in *Using Templates*.

By convention, the template for *action* of *controller* will be in the file `app/views/`*`controller/action.type.xxx`* (where *type* is the file type, such as `html`, `atom`, or `js`; and *xxx* is one of `erb`, `builder`, or `scss`). The `app/views` part of the name is the default. You can override this for an entire application by setting this:

`ActionController.prepend_view_path` *`dir_path`*